

LIFTING TECHNIQUES AND PREVENTING BACK STRAIN





Lifting Techniques and Preventing Back Strain

Introduction

Lifting heavy objects improperly is a common cause of back strain and injury. In this chapter, we will discuss effective lifting techniques and precautions to protect your spine.

Safe Lifting Practices

1. Bend Your Knees, Not Your Back:

When lifting, squat down by bending your knees, and keeping your back straight. This engages your leg muscles, which are stronger and less prone to strain.

2. Maintain a Wide Stance:

Keep your feet shoulder-width apart to provide a stable base of support. This helps distribute the weight evenly.



3. Get a Firm Grip:

Ensure you have a secure grip on the object. Use both hands if possible, and consider wearing gloves for added grip.

4. Keep the Load Close:

Hold the object as close to your body as possible. This minimizes the strain on your back and reduces the leverage.

5. Avoid Twisting While Lifting

Pivot your entire body rather than twisting your spine when changing direction. Twisting can strain the back muscles and ligaments.



3. Use Your Leg Muscles

Push through your legs to lift the object, not through your back. Your leg muscles are larger and stronger, making them better suited for heavy lifting.

4. Maintain a Straight Back:

Throughout the lift, keep your back straight and avoid arching or rounding it. This helps distribute the weight evenly.

Seeking Assistance for Overweight Items

1. Know Your Limits:

Recognize when an object is too heavy for you to lift safely on your own. It's crucial to seek help or use equipment like dollies, carts, or lifting straps.

2. Team Lifting:

When dealing with exceptionally heavy objects, enlist the help of a colleague or friend. Coordinate your movements and communicate to ensure a safe lift.

CONCLUSION



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Practising proper lifting techniques is essential for maintaining a healthy spine. By using your leg muscles, keeping the load close, and avoiding twisting motions, you can significantly reduce the risk of back strain and injury. Remember, it's crucial to know your limits and seek assistance when needed. Prioritising safe lifting practices will contribute to your overall spine health.



About Author



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Sourabh is an NESTA Master Personal Trainer, and an ACSM-certified Personal trainer and Fitness consultant.

Fitness Master Sourabh Kulkarni has **18 plus years** of rich experience in the Fitness Industry. Sourabh has worked as an Instructor of Fitness, Yoga, and Aerobics. .

Sourabh has trained more than **12,000 clients** so far and delivered successful results for Fat Loss, Weight Gain, General Fitness, Hypertension, Diabetes, PCOD & and PCOS, Back Pain (sciatica, herniated disk, bulging disk), Neck Pain (Cervical spondylosis), Knee Pain, Tennis Elbow, Golfers Elbow etc.



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